

A porpoise, not a dolphin

There are six different types of porpoise—this is the harbor porpoise. Porpoises are very shy and, unlike dolphins, tend to swim alone. Their heads are blunt, with no beak.



Spot those spots

Spotted dolphins are born without spots, but develop them as they grow. They appear first on the newborn dolphin's belly, and spread up.

The beak champion

River dolphins have surprisingly long beaks and, unlike many whales, can turn their heads. Both these features help them to poke around on the riverbed for food.

A river dolphin has tiny eyes and finds its way using echolocation.



Scarred for life

It's easy to identify a Risso's dolphin—it is covered in white scars. The scars are caused by fights with other Risso's dolphins.

Risso's is one of the few dolphins with a blunt head.

